[METRIC]

A-A-2801
May 3, 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PENCIL, MECHANICAL FOR 0.9 MM AND 1.1 MM SIZE, COLORED OR BLACK LEADS

This Commercial Item Description has been approved for promulgation by the General Services Administration, office Supplies & Paper Products Commodity Center, New York, NY 10278, and shall be used in preference to Federal Specification SS-P-186E, Type II Class 2.

This description covers mechanical pencils which have two writing points and accommodate 0.9 mm or 1.1 mm size, colored or black leads.

Classification:

The pencils shall be furnished in one the following types and colors as specified in section VIII:

Types:
- A. 0.9 mm
- B. 1.1 mm

Colors:
1. Black
2. Red
3. Blue
4. Other (See section VIII)

I. Salient Characteristics:

A. Mechanical pencils shall consist of a barrel assembly, two metal writing points with a closed spiral type lead advancement mechanism and a metal pocket clip.

B. The mechanical pencil shall be designed to accept, propel, and expel leads at both ends of the pencil.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7520

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

C. The pencil shall have a finger grip between the metal point and barrel, at each end of the pencil. Finger grips shall be the color of the lead contained in the point. The finger grips and metal points shall be formed in accordance with standard commercial practice.

D. The mechanical pencil shall operate by twist action to propel the lead from the point and shall operate smoothly and easily, without binding, bending, breaking or other malfunction.

E. Barrels shall be round or polygonal in shape.

F. The point shall grip the lead firmly, without breaking, so that lead does not turn or slip into or out of the pencil. The pencil shall be capable of dispensing the specified lead size.

G. Lead shall not fall free from the pencil such that the lead when reduced to a length of 7 mm shall continue to be retained in the mechanical pencil.

H. The black lead shall be of graphite or synthetic composition. The colored lead shall be of clay or synthetic composition and colors shall be red, blue or other as specified in section VIII. The definitions of terms relating to the manufacture of the carbon and graphite leads shall be in accordance with ASTM C 709.

I. Each pencil shall be furnished with one lead of the appropriate size, color, and composition for each point. The leads shall be 34.5 +/- 2 mm in length.

J. Workmanship. Mechanical pencils shall be securely assembled so that parts do not become loose or displaced and shall be free from defects or imperfections which may adversely affect appearance or serviceability.

II. Performance A minimum of three leads, of the applicable size, shall be propelled through the mechanical pencil by operating the twist action mechanism, and intermittently performing line drawing and writing actions, without the jamming, falling out, breaking, or failing to feed smoothly. The leads used for this test shall be identical to those supplied with the item.

III. Regulatory requirements. The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

IV. Hazardous material requirements.

A. Material safety data sheets. Safety data shall be furnished in accordance with Fed. Std. 313. The pertinent government mailing addresses for submission of data are listed in appendix B of Fed. Std. 313.

V. Quality assurance requirements.

A. Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order (see VIII), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B. Lot definition. Each lot of pencils shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the sampling plans specified below. The lot shall consist of all pencils of the same type, as applicable, offered for delivery at one time.

C. Examination of the end item for visual defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one pencil. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-3. The AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any pencil containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

Examine	Defects
Workmanship	See Workmanship paragraph
Appearance	Not as specified
Material	Not as specified

D. Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit for this examination shall be one pencil. A random sample shall be taken from each lot in accordance with Inspection Level S-2. The AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective. Samples shall be examined for defects listed below. Any pencil containing one or more defects shall be rejected.

The examination for the characteristics listed in the following table shall be based on the specifications or

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

requirements listed in Notes (see section VIII.) for the specific pencil being examined.

Examine		Defects
Lead:	Length	Not as specified
	Diameter	Not as specified
	Color	Not as specified

E. Tests. Sampling for performance testing shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The inspection level shall be level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one pencil.

Examine	Defects
Performance Test	Does not comply

F. Packaging, Packing, and Marking. Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container inspected for conformance with the requirements of section VI.

VI. Preparation for delivery.

A. Packaging, and packing. Packaging, and packing shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII). The normal commercial number of unit packages shall be packed in a close-fitting fiberboard box used commercially for this item and provide product protection against loss and damage during multiple shipments, handling, and storage. The complete pack shall be in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification and the National Motor Freight Classification. The weight of the shipping container shall not exceed 65 pounds.

B. Marking. Marking shall be as indicated below, unless specified otherwise in the contract or purchase order (see VIII).

1. For Shipment To Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Bar code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

2. For Shipment To Military activities. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129. Bar

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

code marking is required, unless specified otherwise (See VIII).

3. Additional marking. The shipping containers shall include any precautionary marking required by the National Motor Freight Classification Item 222, Uniform Freight Classification Rule 41, and Department of Transportation regulations.

VII. Applicable documents.

The following documents, of the issues in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

A. American Society For Testing Materials (ASTM):
ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

C 709 Standard definitions of terms relating to manufactured carbon and graphite.

B. Public Law and Code of Federal Regulations:
Code of Federal Regulations and Federal Acquisition Regulations are for sale by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

Public Law 94-580 - Use of Recovered Materials
16 CFR Part 1500 - Federal Hazardous Substances Labeling Act.

C. National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc. Agent:
Application for copies shall be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., 2200 Mil Rd., Alexandria, VA 22314.

National Motor Freight Classification

D. Uniform Classification Committee Agent:
Application for copies shall be addressed to the National Railroad Freight Committee, Suite 1120, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.

Uniform Freight Classification

D. Federal Standards, Specifications, and Commercial Item Descriptions:
Federal standards and specifications are available from GSA Business Service Centers and GSA Specification Unit (3FBP-W), 7th and D streets SW., Washington, D.C. 20407.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Single copies of this specification and other specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Auburn, Washington.

FED-STD-123 Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-313 Material Safety Data, Transportation Data and Disposal Data for Hazardous Materials Furnished to Government Activities.

E. Military Standards:
Military Standards are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Bldg. 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

MIL-STD-105 Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 Marking for Shipment and Storage.

VIII. Notes.

A. Ordering information. Purchasers shall select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

1) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
2) Purchasers shall specify the pencil type, size of lead and colors required. If color 4 (other) is required the specific color shall be specified.
3) Purchasers shall specify arrangement for inspection and inspection facilities, if other than specified (see tests and quality assurance requirements.)
4) Purchasers shall specify packaging and packing, any special marking for shipment required, if other than required (see preparation for delivery).
5) Identification marking, if other than required.
6) If bar code marking is not required.
7) MSDS's required, in addition to those required by Fed-Std-313.
8) Purchasers shall specify palletization, if required.
9) Purchasers shall specify eraser and eraser hardness, if required.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

B. Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (For classification use, only):

AA2801 - A1 (This part number describes a 0.9 mm mechanical pencil (Type I) with 0.9 mm Black lead in accordance with CID A-A-2801.)

- Color:
  1. Black
  2. Red
  3. Blue
  4. Other
- Type:
  A. 0.9 mm
  B. 1.1 mm

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DOD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

Preparing Activity:
GSA-FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.